

Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

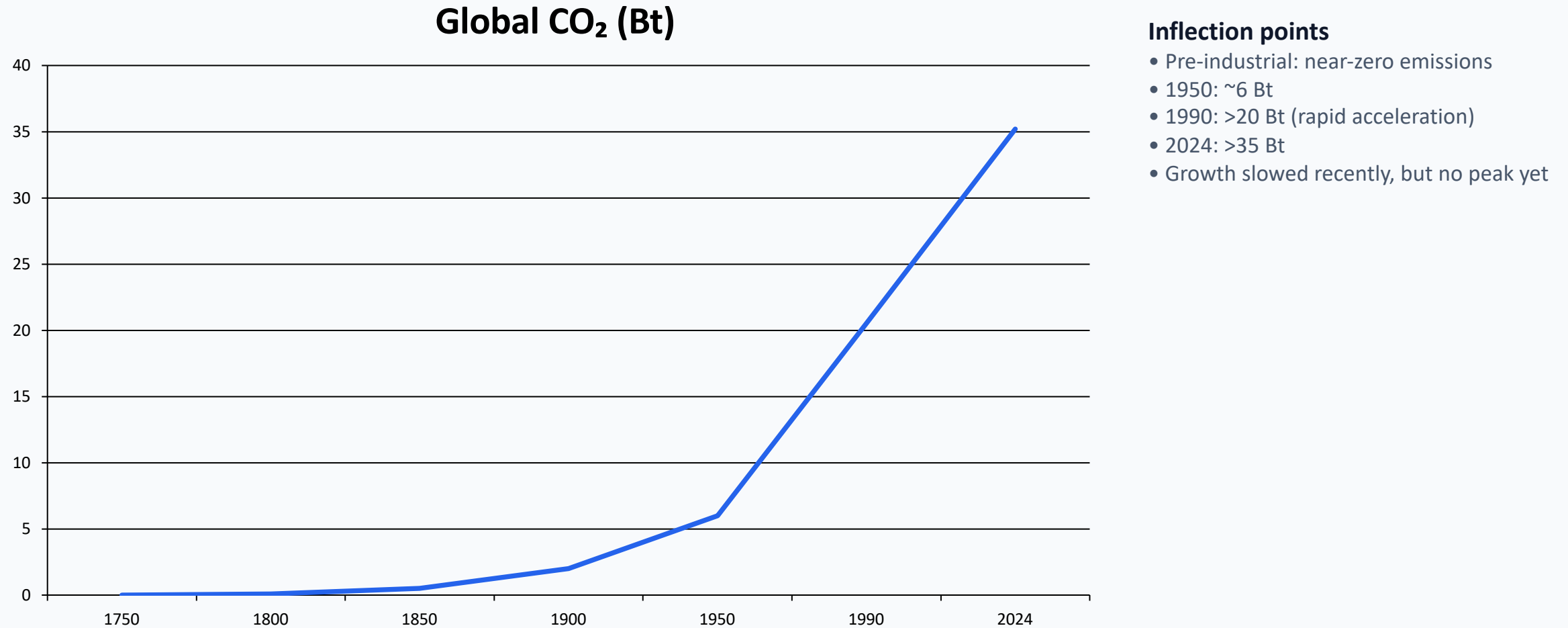
Fossil fuels & industry, 1750–2024

A data-driven overview of global CO₂ emission trends by country, region, and per capita.

Audience: policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers.

Data attribution: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data (Ritchie & Roser).

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third

[Stacked area chart placeholder]

Share of global CO₂ emissions by region, 1900–2024

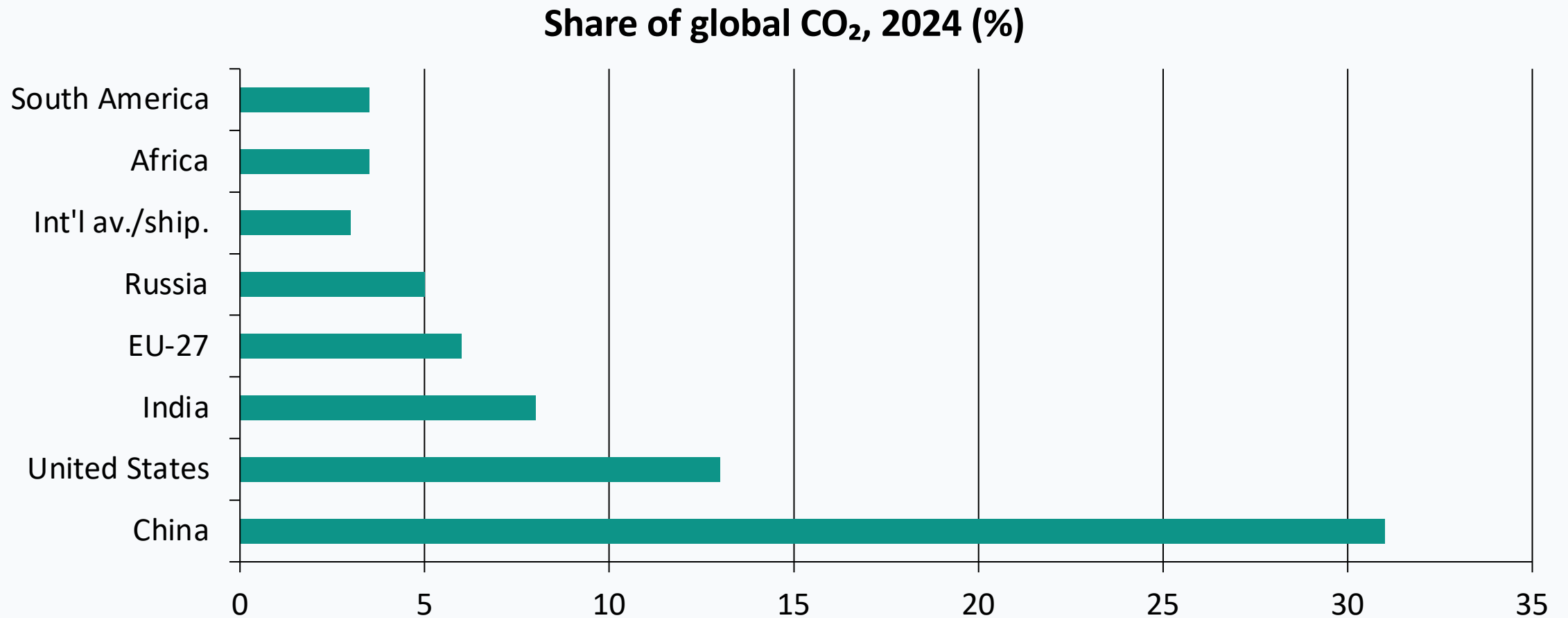
- 1900: Europe + US >90%
- 1950: Europe + US >85%
- Today: Europe + US <1/3
- Asia now ~half of global emissions, led by China

Narrative pivot

Historical dominance sat in Europe and North Am

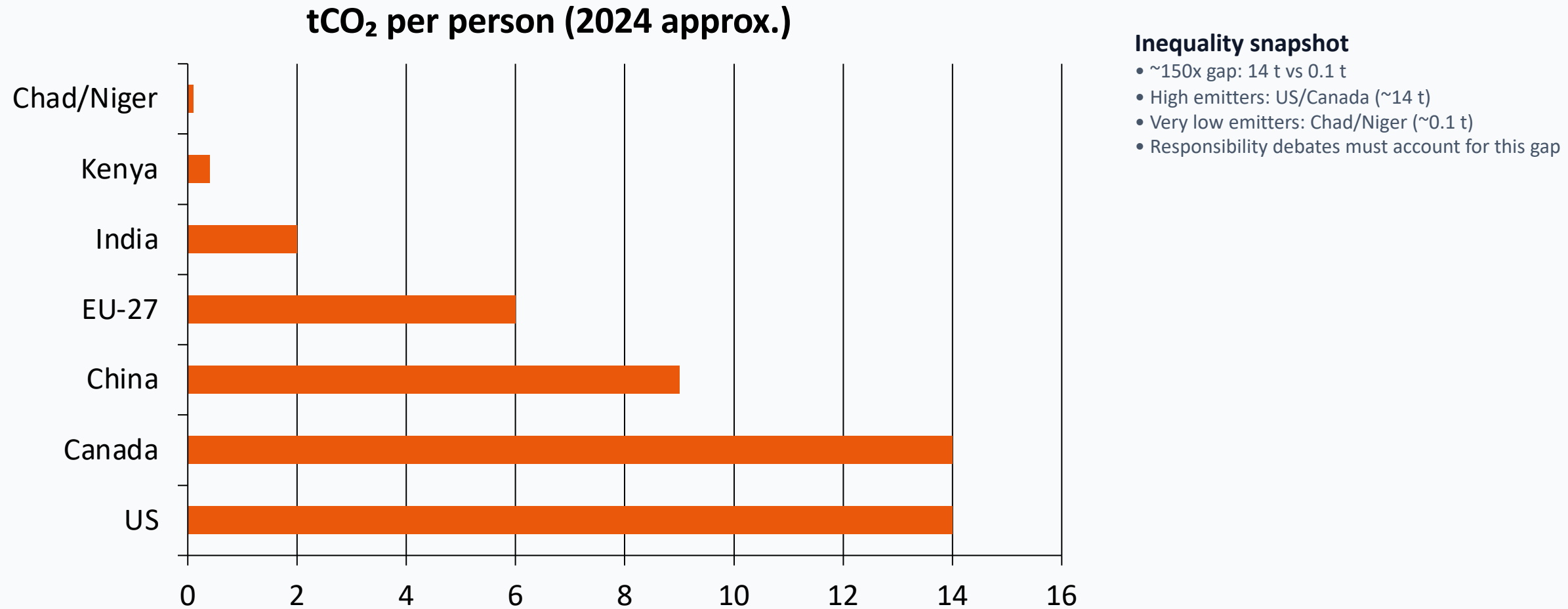
Current annual emissions center of gravity has shi

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂

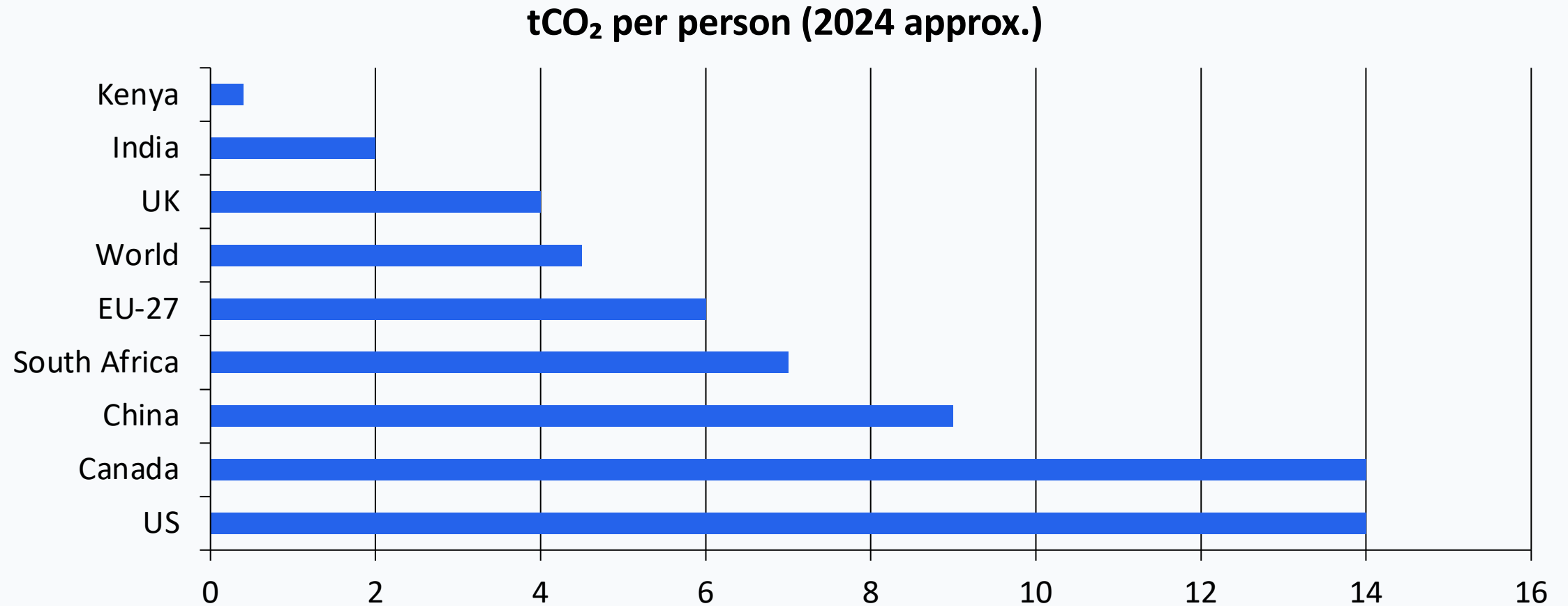


China (~31%) is the largest annual emitter; the US (~13%) is a distant second.

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2



China is the largest total emitter, but at ~9 t/person remains below the US (~14 t); India stays much lower at ~2 t.

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia

[Diverging bar / choropleth placeholder]

Annual % change in CO₂ emissions, 2024

- Blue = declines (US, much of EU, UK)
- Orange/red = increases (Russia, parts of Southeast Asia, several African nations)
- Some Central Asian countries >10% increases

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than

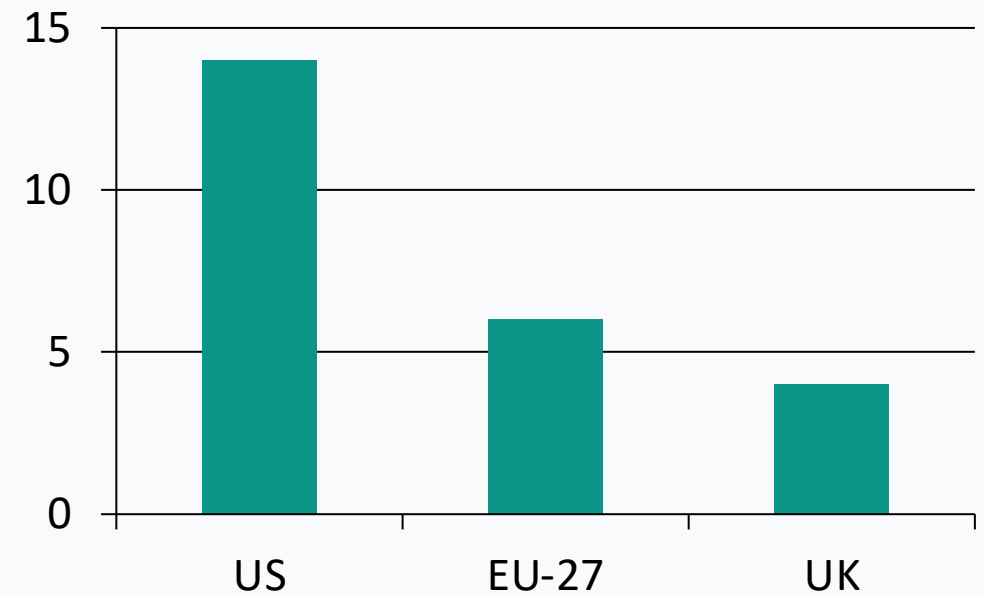
Core insight

Among similarly wealthy countries, per capita emissions diverge due to energy mix.

France, the UK, and Portugal are lower partly because electricity relies more on nuclear and renewables.

Germany, the Netherlands, and especially the US remain higher where fossil fuel dependence is greater.

Per capita CO₂ (t)



Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- Global fossil-fuel-and-industry CO₂ emissions exceed 35 Bt/year and have not yet peaked.
- China is the largest annual emitter (~31%), but per capita emissions remain below the US (~14 t vs ~9 t).
- Historical annual shares were dominated by Europe and the US (>90% in 1900), now under one-third.
- Per capita gaps remain extreme: ~150x between ~0.1 t (Chad/Niger) and ~14 t (US/Canada).
- Energy policy and technology choices can reduce emissions without sacrificing prosperity.